

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

ADVENTURE

LECTURE-1

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

- 1 ... Lec.1. (The Adventure) Detailed explanation.
- 2 ...
- 3 ...
- 4 ...

The Adventure Jayant Narlikar

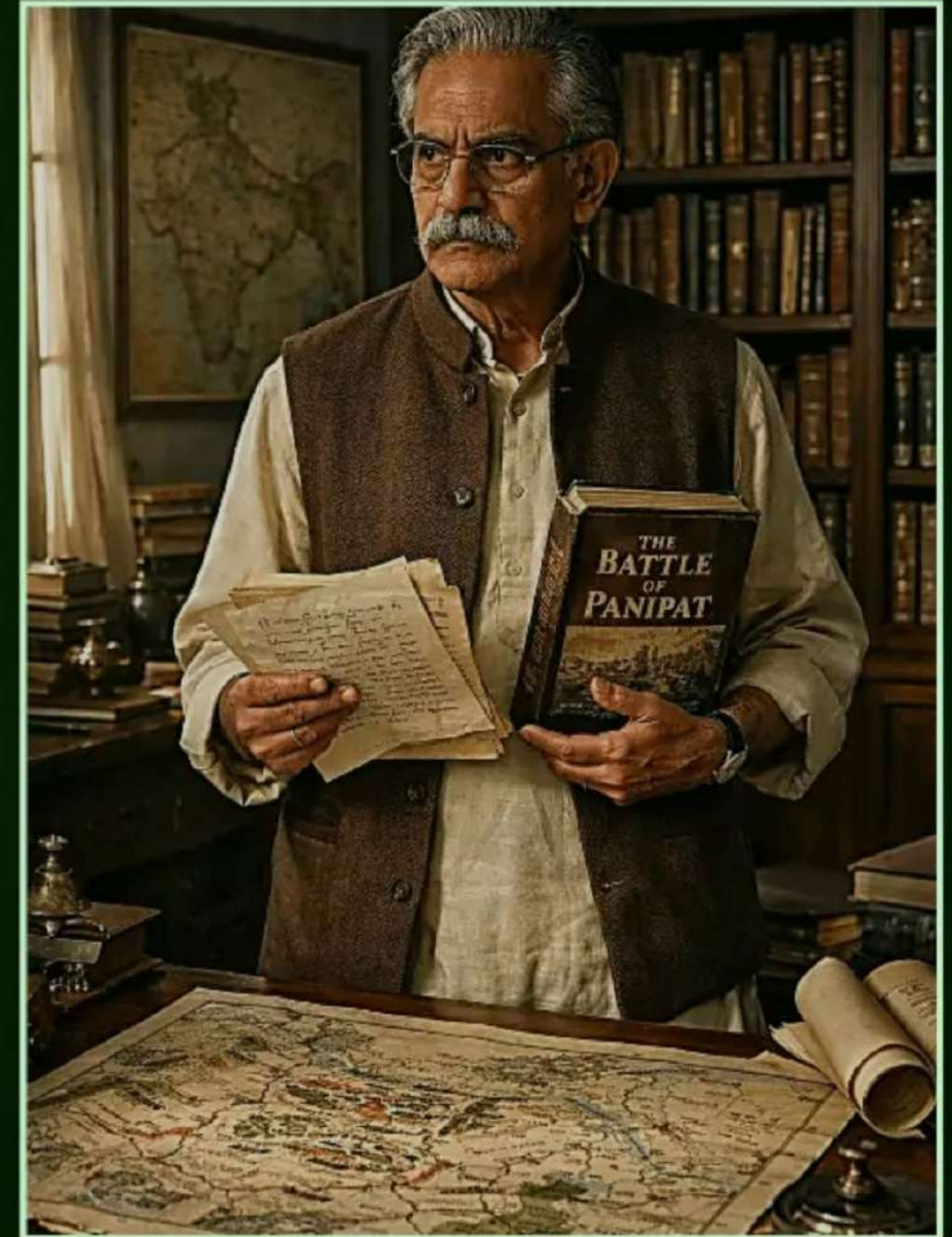


Main Character
Professor Gangadharpant Gaitonde

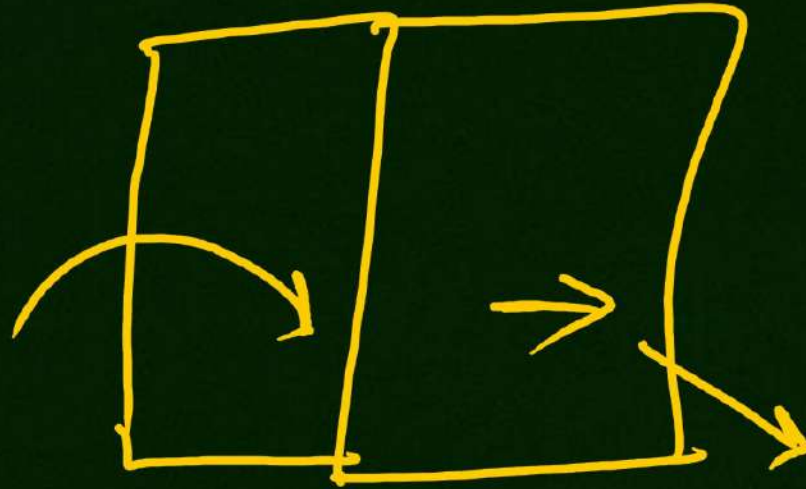
Main character and protagonist of the story.

A history professor who is deeply involved in studying the Battle of Panipat. Known for giving public lectures and being passionate about historical accuracy. Experiences a mysterious journey into a parallel world where history took a different turn — the Marathas won the Battle of Panipat.

His experience raises questions about reality, history, and alternate universes. Returns to his original world and tries to understand his experience through science (Catastrophe Theory) and rational explanation.



The Adventure



History

① Professor

⇒ 999 → Lectures.

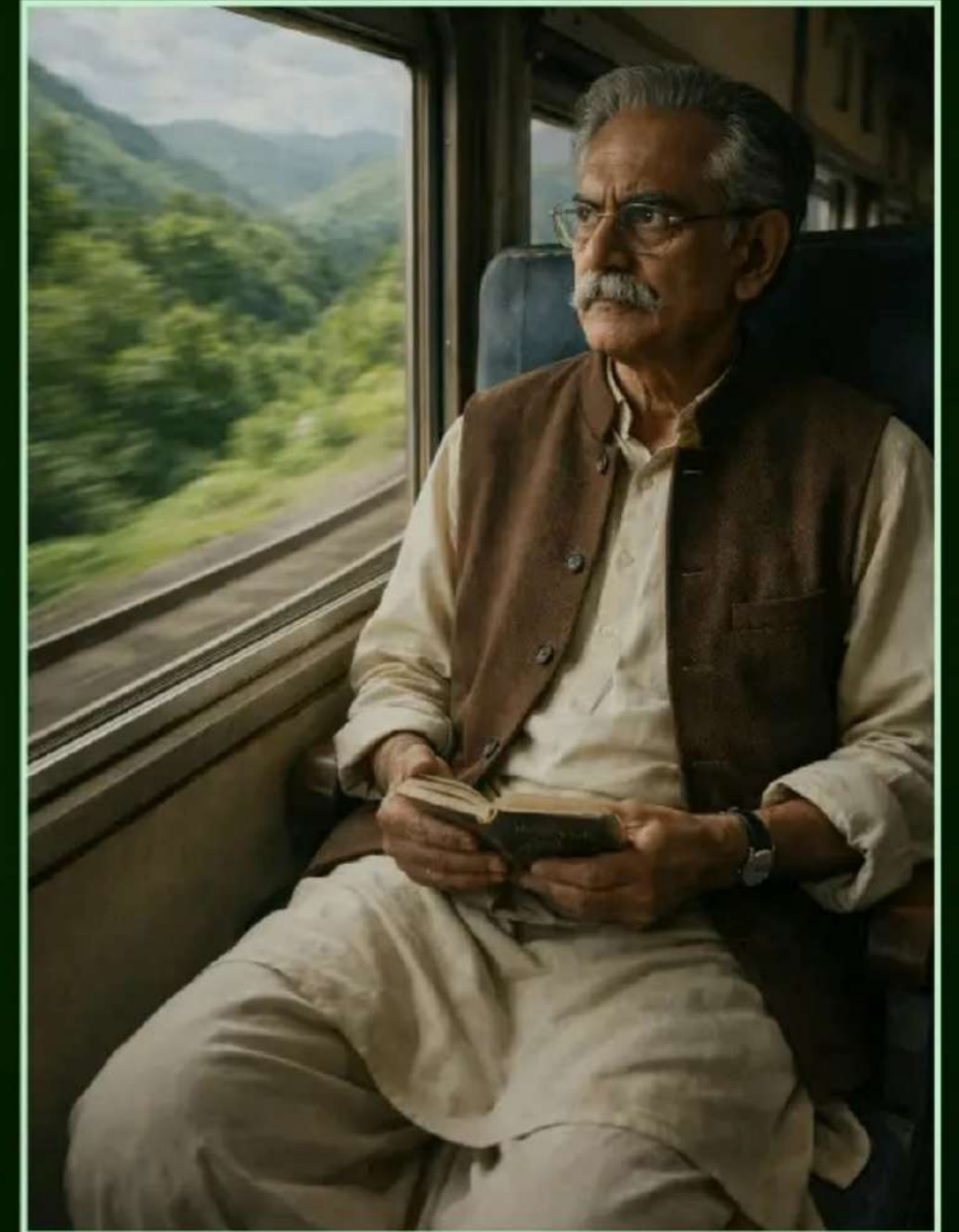
1000th → Battle of Panipat.

Truck -

He met an accident
→ parallel world.

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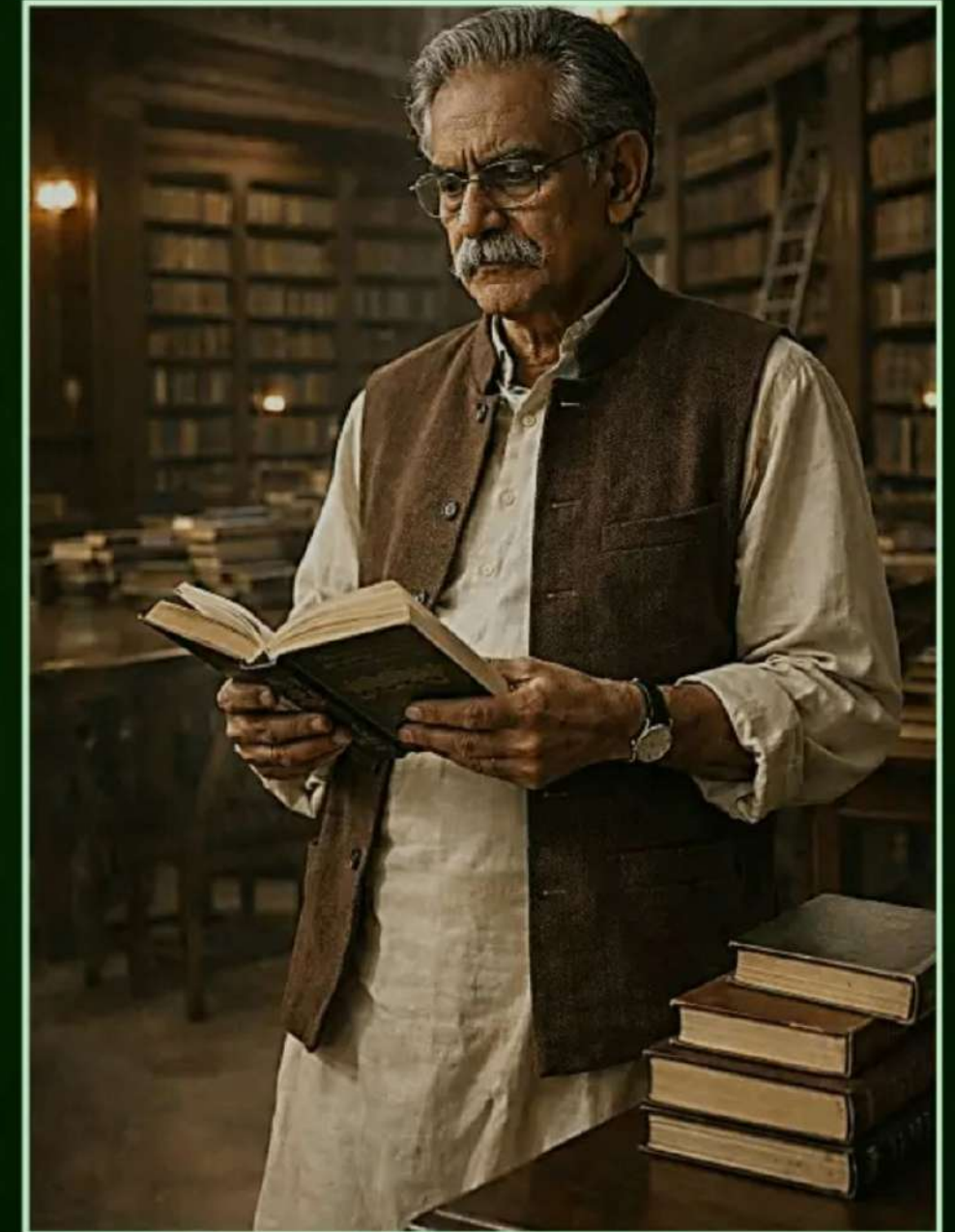
The ^{name of the train} Jijamata Express sped along the Pune-Bombay* route considerably faster than the ^{train} Deccan Queen. There were no industrial townships outside Pune. The first stop, Lonavala, came in 40 minutes. The ghat section that followed was no different from what he knew. The train stopped at Karjat only briefly and went on at even greater speed. It roared through Kalyan.



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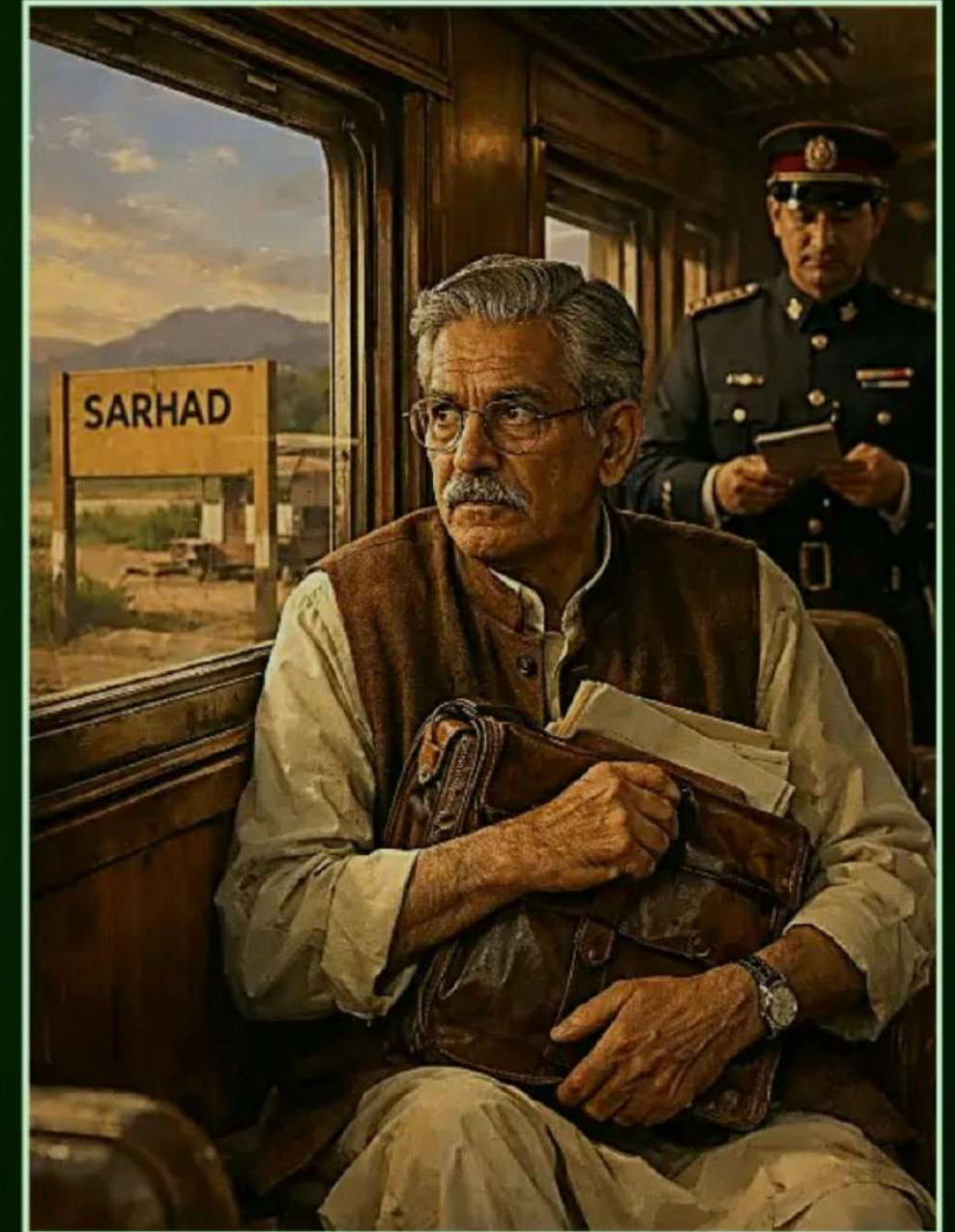
Meanwhile, the racing mind of Professor Gaitonde had arrived at a plan of action in Bombay. Indeed, as a historian he felt he should have thought of it sooner. He would go to a big library and browse through history books. That was the surest way of finding out how the present state of affairs was reached. He also planned eventually to return to Pune and have a long talk with Rajendra Deshpande, who would surely help him understand what had happened.



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That is, assuming that in this world there existed someone called Rajendra Deshpande!

The train stopped beyond the long tunnel. It was a small station called Sarhad. An Anglo-Indian in uniform went through the train checking permits



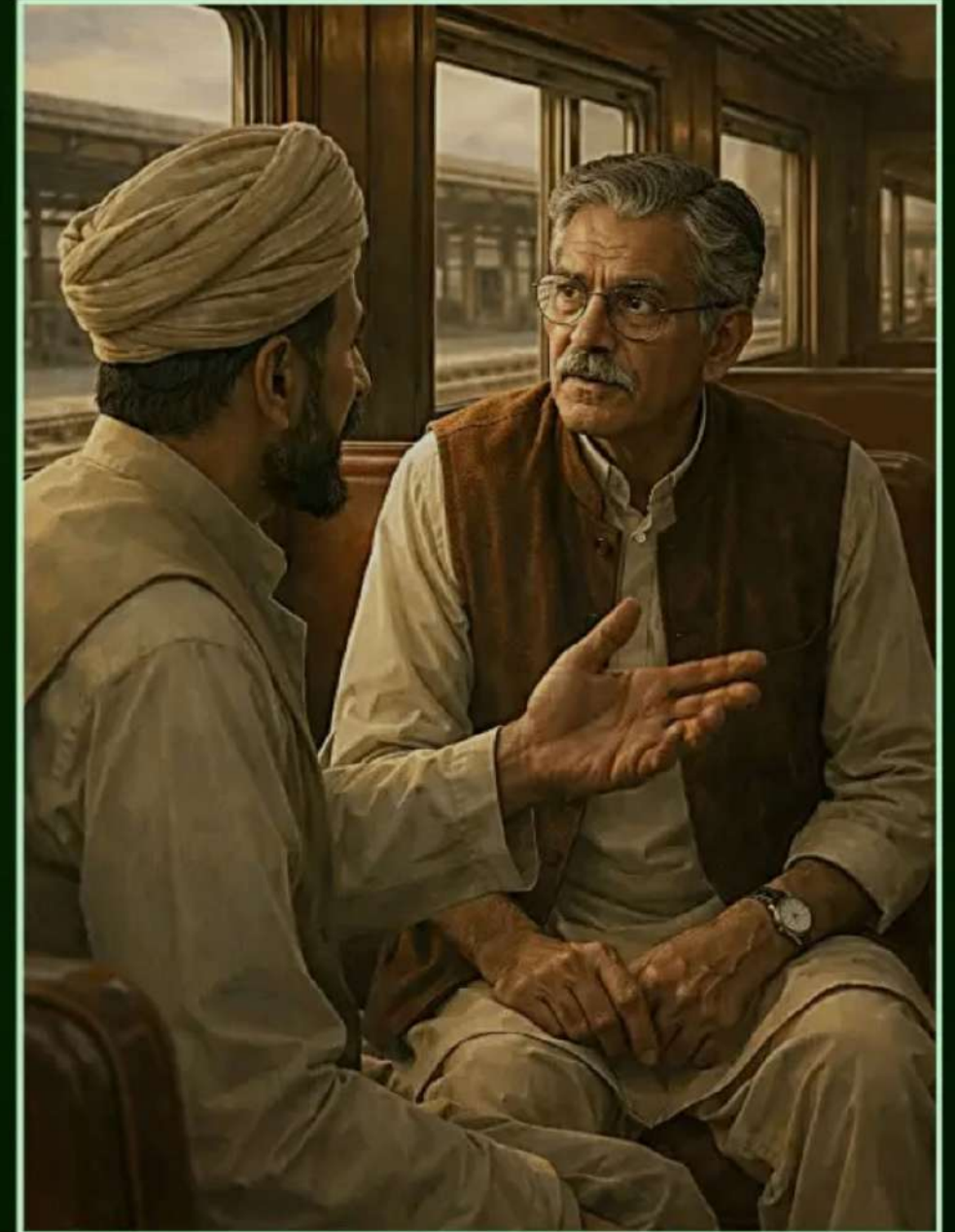
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“This is where the British Raj begins. You are going for the first time, I presume?” Khan Sahib asked.

“Yes.” The reply was factually correct. Gangadharpant had not been to this Bombay before. He ventured a question: “And, Khan Sahib, how will you go to Peshawar?”

“This train goes to the Victoria Terminus*
(Now knownss Chattrapati Shivaji Terminus) I will take the Frontier Mail tonight out of Central.”

“How far does it go? By what route?”



The Adventure Jayant Narlikar



“Bombay to Delhi, then to Lahore and then Peshawar. A long journey. I will reach Peshawar the day after tomorrow.”

Thereafter, Khan Sahib spoke a lot about his business and Gangadharpant was a willing listener. For, in that way, he was able to get some flavour of life in this India that was so different.

The train now passed through the suburban rail traffic. The blue carriages carried the letters, GBMR, on the side.

“Greater Bombay Metropolitan Railway,” explained Khan Sahib. “See the tiny ^{Flag} Union Jack painted on each carriage? A gentle reminder that we are in British territory.”

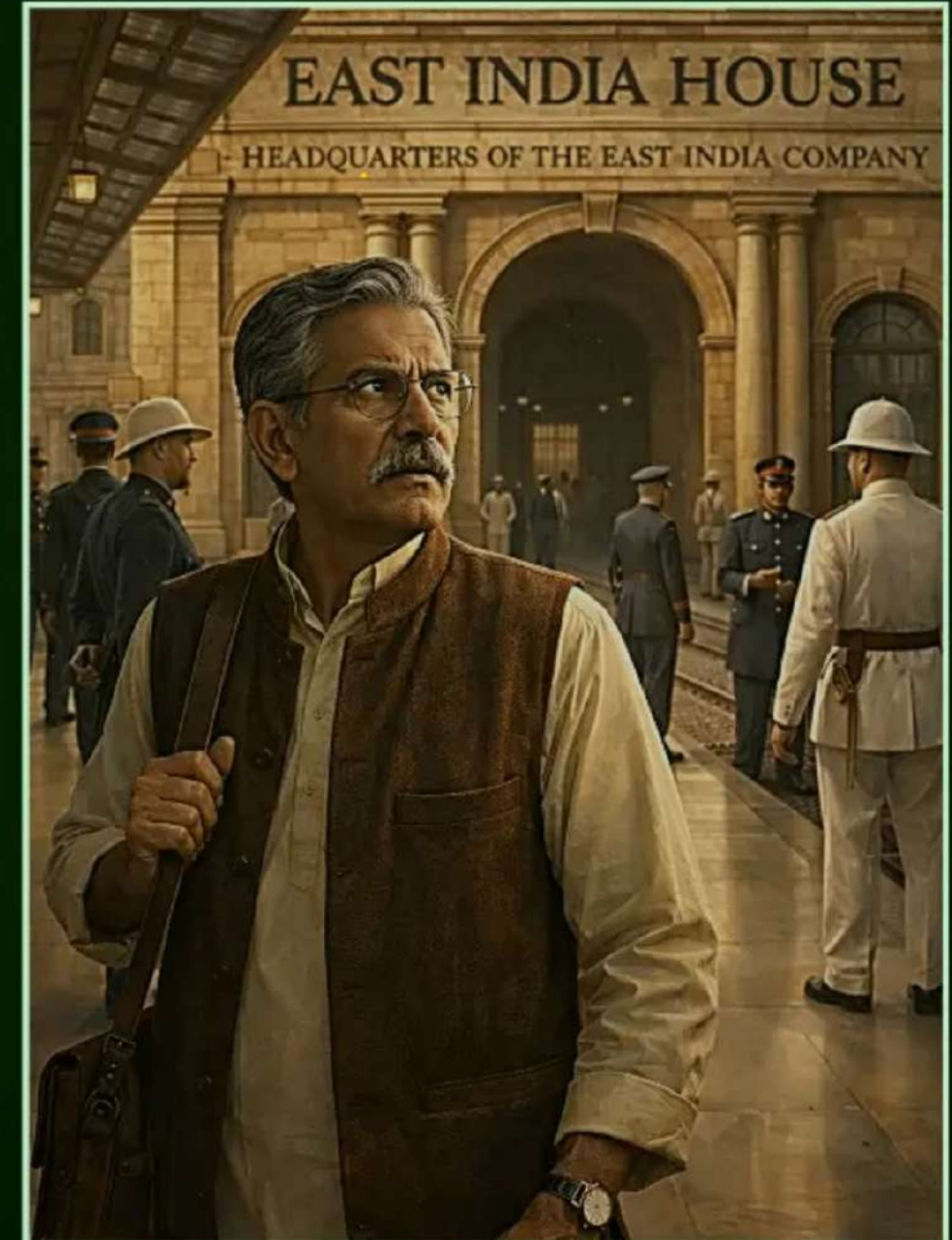


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The train began to slow down beyond Dadar and stopped only at its destination, Victoria Terminus. The station looked remarkably neat and clean. The staff was mostly made up of Anglo-Indians and Parsees along with a handful of British officers.

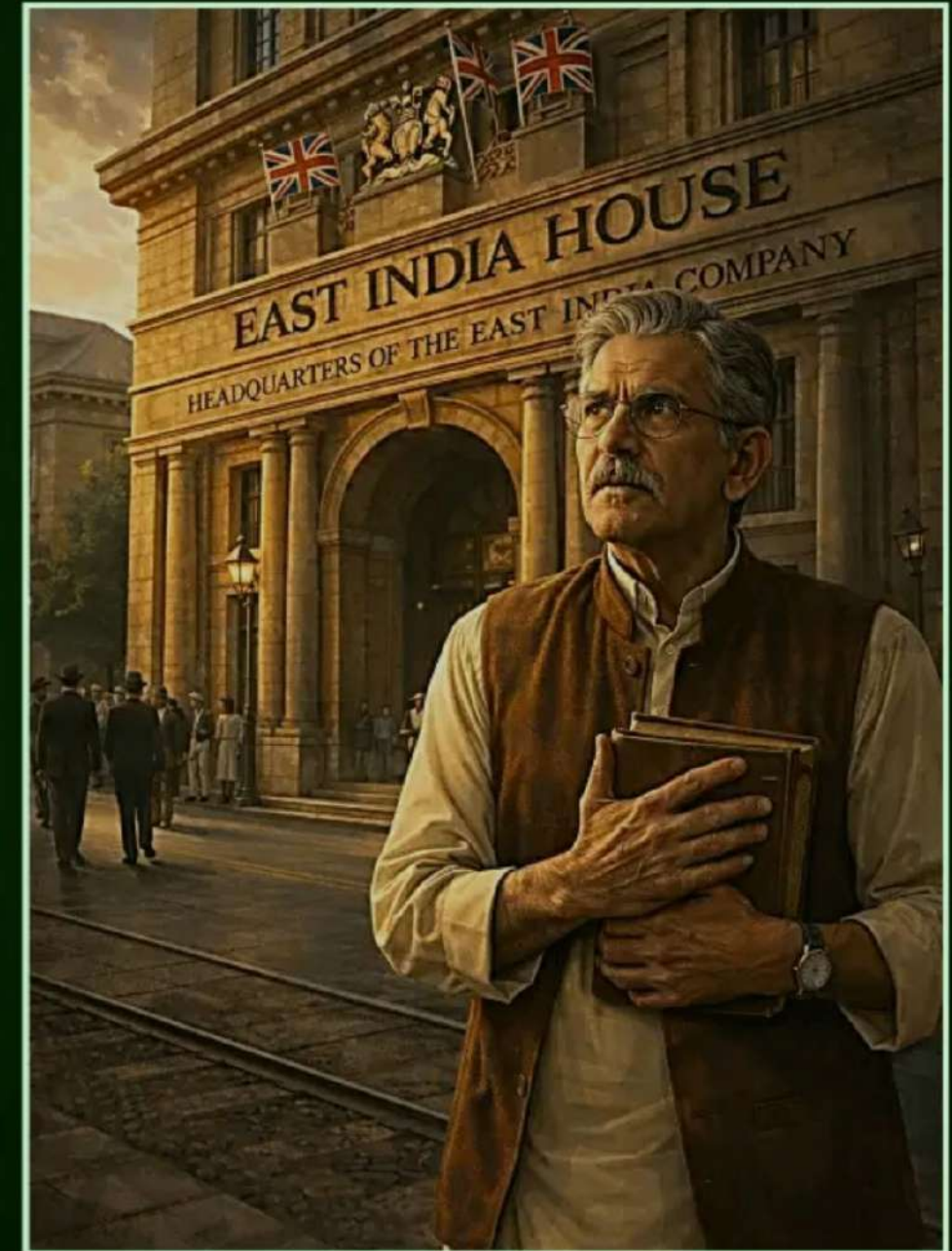
As he came out from the station, Gangadharpant found himself facing an imposing building. The letters on it proclaimed its identity to those who did not know this Bombay landmark:

**EAST INDIA HOUSE HEADQUARTERS OF THE EAST
INDIA COMPANY**



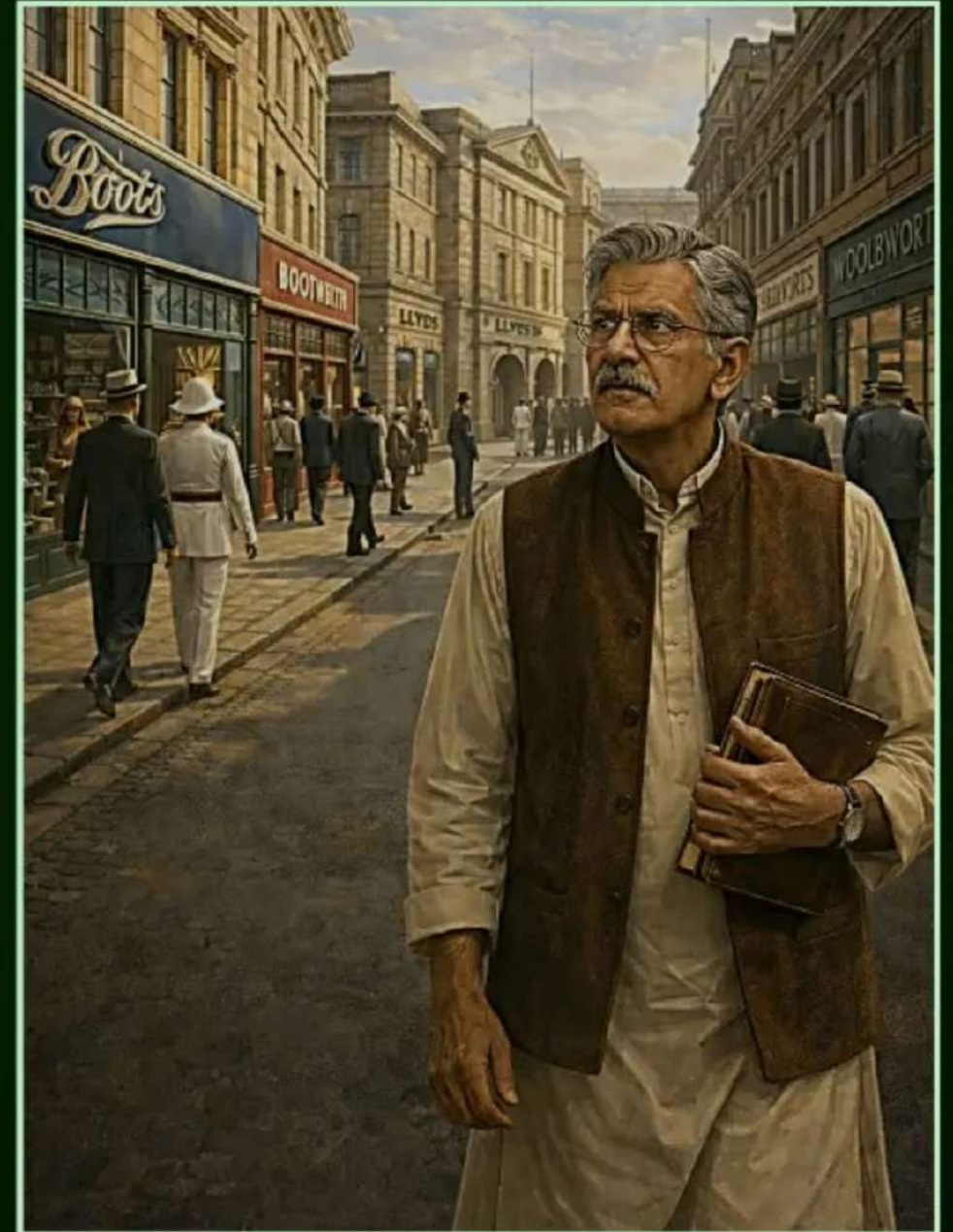
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Prepared as he was for many shocks, Professor Gaitonde had not expected this. The East India Company had been ^{closed, ended} wound up shortly after the events of 1857 — at least, that is what history books said. Yet, here it was, not only alive but ^{growing well} flourishing. So, history had taken a different turn, perhaps before 1857. How and when had it happened? He had to find out.



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As he walked along Hornby Road, as it was called, he found a different set of shops and office buildings. There was no Handloom House building. Instead, there were Boots and Woolworth departmental stores, imposing offices of Lloyds, Barclays and other British banks, as in a typical high street of a town in England.



The Adventure Jayant Narlikar



He turned right along Home Street and entered Forbes building.

“I wish to meet Mr Vinay Gaitonde, please,” he said to the English receptionist.

She searched through the telephone list, the staff list and then through the directory of employees of all the branches of the firm. She shook her head and said, “I am ^{Sorry} afraid I can’t find anyone of that name either here or in any of our branches. Are you sure he works here?”



The Adventure Jayant Narlikar



This was a ^{shock} blow, not totally unexpected. If he himself were dead in this world, what guarantee had he that his son would be alive? Indeed, he may not even have been born!

He thanked the girl politely and came out. It was characteristic of him not to worry about where he would stay. His main concern was to make his way to the library of the Asiatic Society to solve the riddle of history. Grabbing a quick lunch at a restaurant, he made his way to the Town Hall.

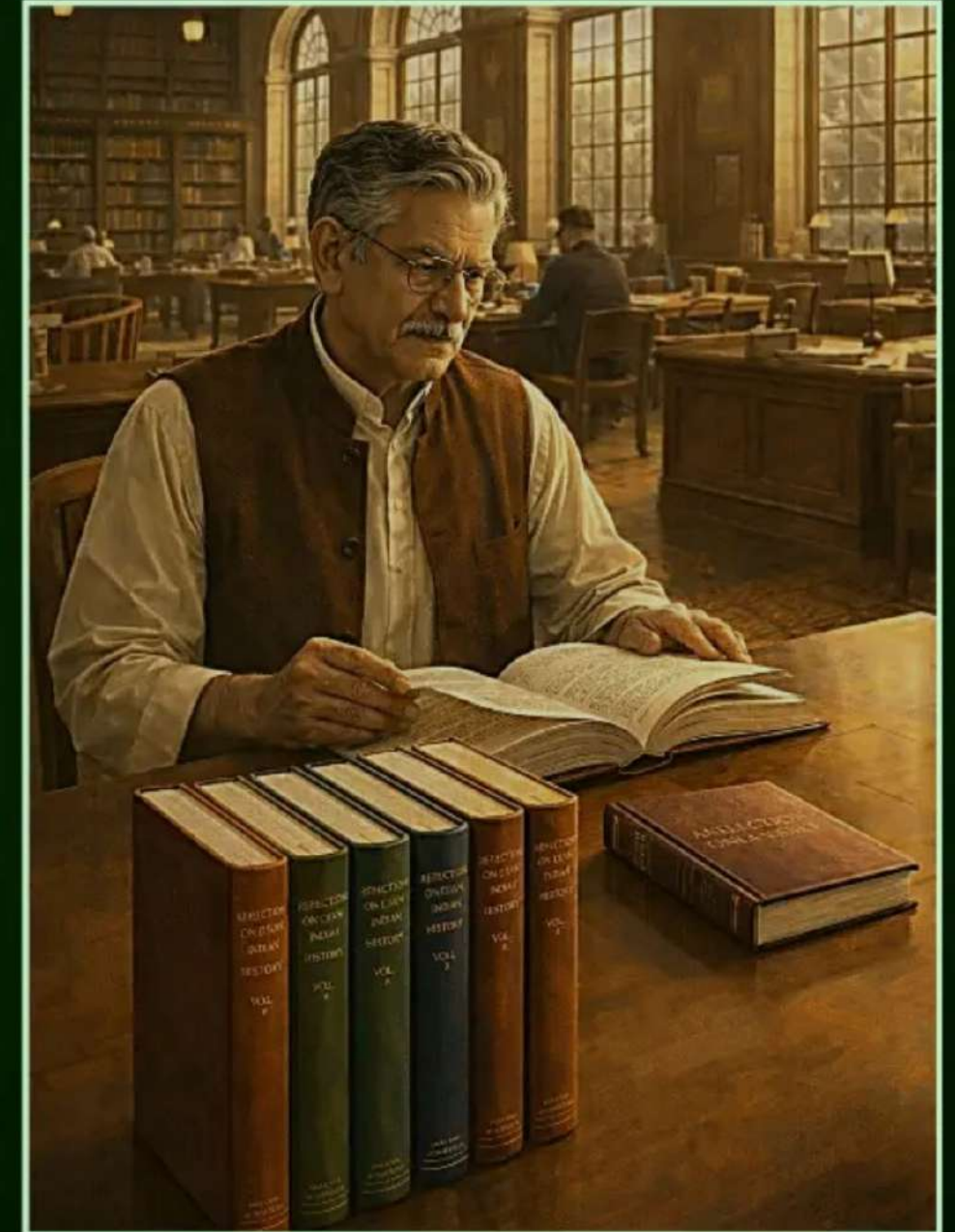


The Adventure Jayant Narlikar



Yes, to his relief, the Town Hall was there, and it did house the library. He entered the reading room and asked for a list of history books including his own.

His five volumes duly arrived on his table. He started from the beginning. Volume one took the history up to the period of Ashoka, volume two up to Samudragupta, volume three up to Mohammad Ghor and volume four up to the death of Aurangzeb. Up to this period history was as he knew it. The change evidently had occurred in the last volume.

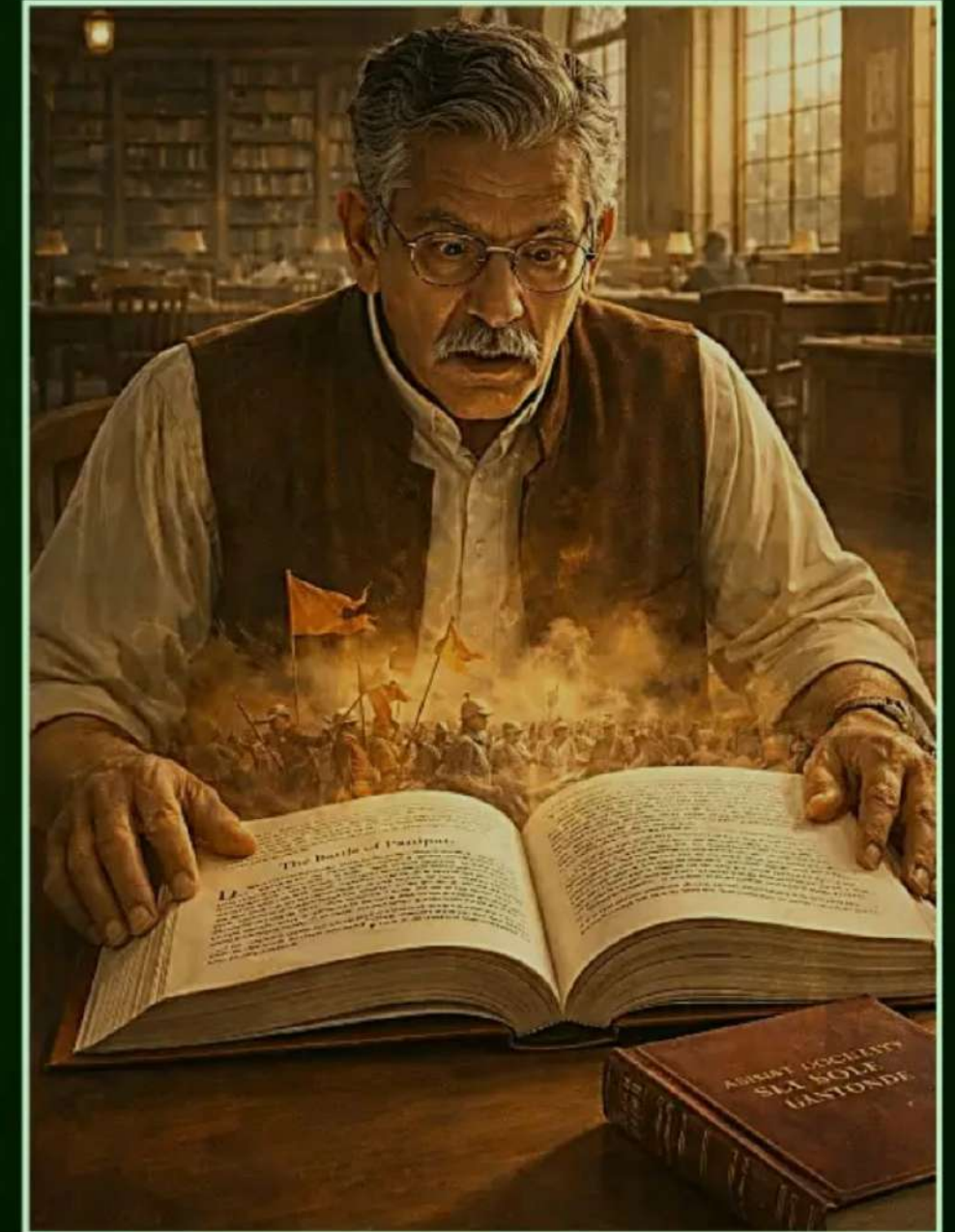


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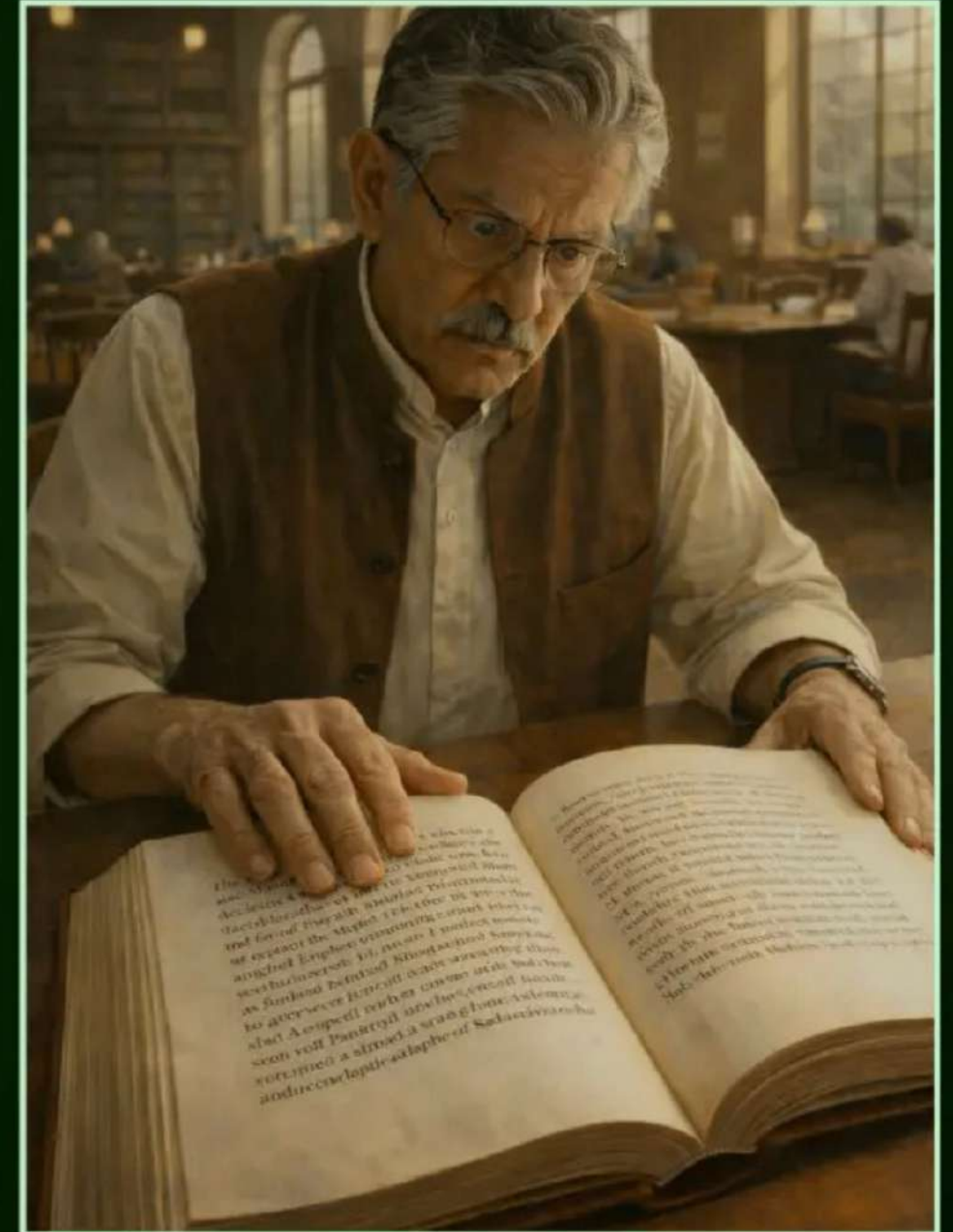
Reading volume five from both ends inwards, Gangadharpant finally ^{reached} converged on the precise moment where history had taken a different turn.

That page in the book described the **Battle of Panipat**, and it mentioned that the Marathas won it handsomely. **Abdali** was routed and he was chased back to Kabul by the triumphant Maratha army led by **Sadashivrao Bhau** and his nephew, the young **Vishwasrao**.



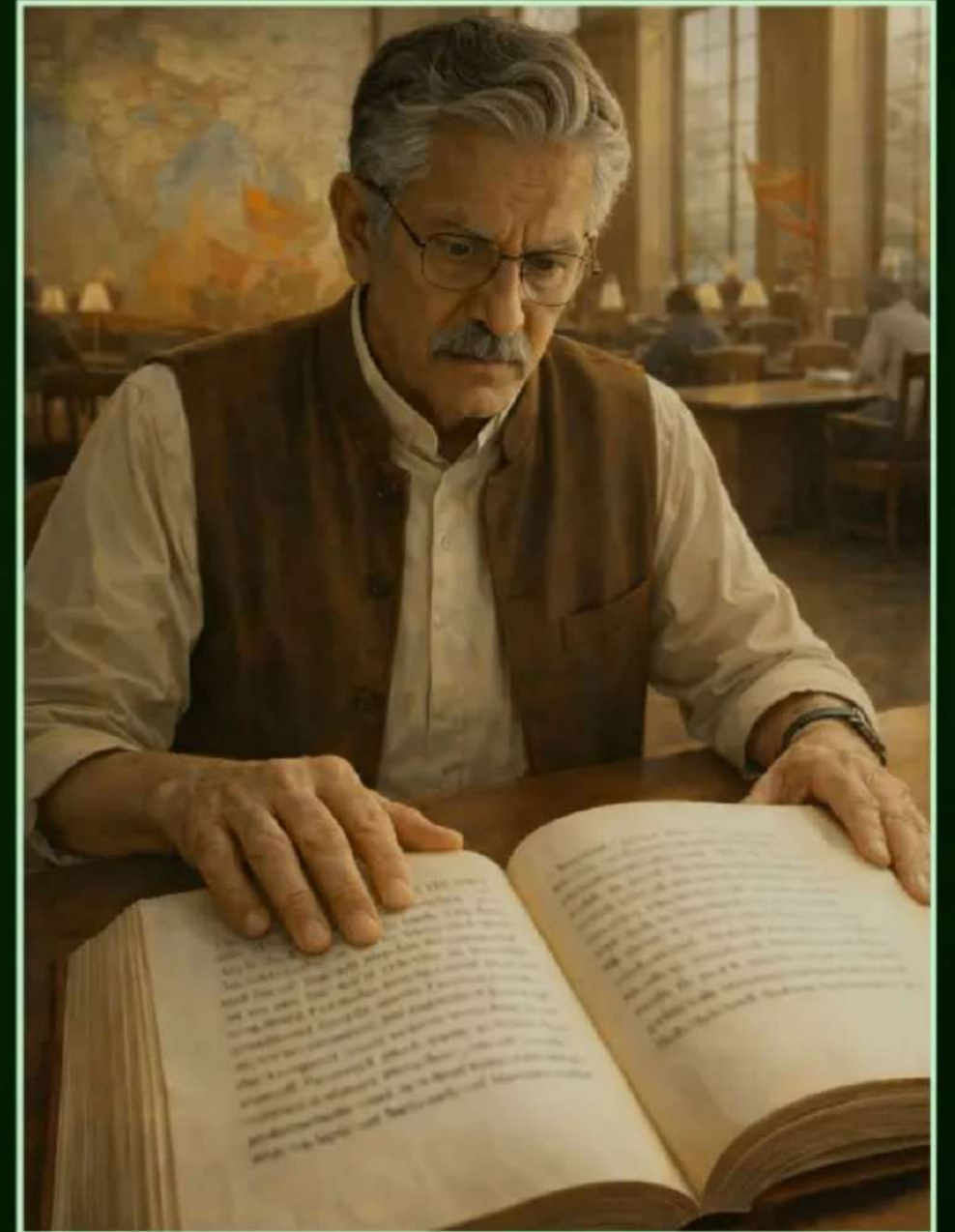
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The book did not go into a ^{set by step} blow-by-blow account of the battle itself. Rather, it elaborated in detail its consequences for the power struggle in India. Gangadharpant read through the account ^{eagerly} avidly. The style of writing was unmistakably his, yet he was reading the account for the first time!



The Adventure Jayant Narlikar

Their victory in the battle was not only a great morale booster to the Marathas but it also established their supremacy in northern India. The East India Company, which had been watching these developments from the sidelines, got the message and temporarily ^{postponed} shelved its expansionist programme.



QUESTION



Who is the main character in the story "The Adventure"?

- 1 Rajendra Deshpande
- 2 Professor Gaitonde ~~✗~~
- 3 Ahmad Shah Abdali
- 4 Jayant Narlikar

QUESTION



What subject does Professor Gaitonde specialize in?

- 1 Physics
- 2 Literature
- 3 History ~~///~~
- 4 Chemistry

QUESTION



Which historical event is central to the story?

1 First War of Independence

2 The Partition of India,

3 Battle of Panipat ~~///~~

4 Quit India Movement

Thank
You